DYURTYULI — OUR NATIVE LAND

WORKSHEET A

English · Grade 10 · Reading, Vocabulary, Word Formation, Writing

NAME | CLASS | DATE

TEXT · Read carefully — you will need it for Tasks 2–5

Dyurtyuli is a small town in the north-west of the Republic of Bashkortostan, about 124 kilometres from Ufa, the capital of the republic. It stands on the left bank of the Belaya River, which the Bashkirs call Agidel — 'the White Water'. According to a local legend, the settlement was founded in 1795 by four merchants, and its name comes from the Bashkir words meaning 'four houses'. For a long time Dyurtyuli remained a quiet rural settlement, but during the 20th century it began to gather pace: new factories, schools and a railway station changed the life of the village. In 1989 Dyurtyuli received the status of a town. Today about 30,000 people live here. Agriculture, especially wheat growing, still plays an important part in the local economy, and the town is known for its friendly people, its riverside embankment and the House of Culture, where singers and dancers perform every weekend.

1 MATCH THE WORDS WITH THEIR DEFINITIONS

___ / 8 pts

Match the words (1–8) with their definitions (a–h).

1. to found	e) to start or establish a settlement, a school or a company
2. a merchant	a) a person who buys and sells goods, often a rich one
3. an embankment	f) a road or a wall along the side of a river
4. rural	g) connected with the countryside, not with a big city
5. to gather pace	h) to become faster, stronger or more active
6. status	b) the official position of a place: a village, a town or a city
7. wheat	c) a plant whose grain is used to make flour and bread
8. population	d) all the people who live in a particular place

Answers: **1.** ___ **2.** ___ **3.** ___ **4.** ___ **5.** ___ **6.** ___ **7.** ___ **8.** ___

2 WORD FORMATION

___ / 8 pts

Use the word in capitals to form a new word that fits each gap.

1. The settlement was _____ by four merchants in 1795. (FOUND)
2. Dyurtyuli is _____ in the north-west of Bashkortostan, 124 km from Ufa. (LOCATE)
3. In 1989 the settlement _____ the status of a town. (RECEIVE)
4. Agriculture still plays an _____ part in the local economy. (IMPORTANCE)
5. The town is _____ for its friendly people and busy cultural life. (FAME)
6. The population of the town has been _____ since the middle of the 20th century. (GROW)
7. The Belaya is one of the _____ rivers in the republic. (BEAUTY)
8. Every summer the embankment _____ crowds of visitors. (ATTRACT)

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WORKSHEET B

Reading for detail · Vocabulary in use

3 MULTIPLE CHOICE

___ / 6 pts

Choose the correct answer (A, B or C) according to the text.

1. Where is Dyurtyuli situated?
A in the south-east of Bashkortostan B in the north-west of the republic
C in the centre of Ufa

2. What does the name 'Dyurtyuli' mean, according to the legend?
A 'four houses' B 'white water' C 'new village'

3. When was the settlement founded?
A in 1789 B in 1795 C in 1989

4. When did Dyurtyuli receive the status of a town?
A in 1964 B in 1795 C in 1989

5. Which river does the town stand on?
A the Agidel (the Belaya) B the Ufa C the Volga

6. What branch of the economy is still important in the area?
A shipbuilding B agriculture C tourism

7. How far is Dyurtyuli from the capital of the republic?
A about 30 km B about 124 km C about 240 km

4 TRUE / FALSE / NOT STATED

___ / 6 pts

Read the statements. Write T (true), F (false) or NS (the text does not say).

	T	F	NS
1. Dyurtyuli is the capital of the Republic of Bashkortostan.	☐	☐	☐
2. The town stands on the left bank of the Belaya River.	☐	☐	☐
3. The name 'Dyurtyuli' means 'four houses'.	☐	☐	☐
4. More than a million people live in Dyurtyuli.	☐	☐	☐
5. The text mentions the exact number of schools in the town.	☐	☐	☐
6. Farmers in the area grow wheat.	☐	☐	☐

DID YOU KNOW?
The Dyurtyuli land is the birthplace of the famous Bashkir poets Nazar Nadjmi and Shaikhzada Babich. And in the 1950s the development of the Mancharovo oil field changed the life of the village: it soon turned into a workers' settlement, and later — into a town.

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WORKSHEET C

Speaking · Writing · Self-assessment

5 OPEN QUESTIONS

___ / 4 pts

Answer the questions in full sentences. Give reasons and examples.

Why is the town called 'Dyurtyuli'?

What is Agidel and what does this name mean?

How did life in Dyurtyuli change during the 20th century?

Would you like to live in a small town? Why (not)?

6 WRITING · AN OPINION ESSAY

___ / 10 pts

Write an essay of 120–150 words. Follow the plan and use the linking words.

> **“Some people think that life in a small town is boring, while others believe that small towns are the best place to grow up. What is your opinion?”**

PLAN

1) Introduction: the problem and your opinion
2) Main body: two or three arguments with examples
3) Conclusion: sum up your ideas

USEFUL LINKING WORDS

Firstly · In addition · Moreover
However · On the one hand … on the other hand
To sum up · In conclusion · All in all

SELF-ASSESSMENT

How do you feel about this topic now? Circle the face:

 Easy for me  OK  Difficult

MY SCORE:_____

Total: ____ / 42 pts

TEACHER'S KEY

ANSWERS

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TASK 1 · Matching (1 point each)

1 – e (to found) 2 – a (a merchant) 3 – f (an embankment) 4 – g (rural)
5 – h (to gather pace) 6 – b (status) 7 – c (wheat) 8 – d (population)

TASK 2 · Word formation (1 point each)

1 founded 2 located 3 received 4 important 5 famous
6 growing 7 most beautiful 8 attracts

TASK 3 · Multiple choice (1 point each)

1 – B 2 – A 3 – B 4 – C 5 – A 6 – B 7 – B

TASK 4 · True / False / Not stated (1 point each)

1 – F (Ufa is the capital) 2 – T 3 – T 4 – F (about 30,000 people)
5 – NS 6 – T

TASK 5 · Suggested answers (1 point each)

1. The town is called 'Dyurtyuli' because, according to the legend, four merchants founded the settlement — the name of the town means 'four houses'.
2. Agidel is the Bashkir name of the river Belaya; the name means 'the White Water'.
3. New factories, schools and a railway station appeared, and in 1989 the settlement became a town.
4. Students' own answers — accept any logical, grammatically correct response.

TASK 6 · Sample answer (for the teacher)

I have lived in a small town all my life, and I believe it is a great place to grow up. Firstly, small towns are safe and friendly: people know and help each other. Secondly, nature is very close — you can walk along the embankment or go to the river after school. However, a small town offers fewer opportunities for study and work. On the other hand, modern transport and the Internet partly solve this problem. To sum up, I am sure that life in a small town teaches us to value people and nature. (≈ 95 words — a good, slightly shorter model)

TASK 6 · Assessment criteria

Content 2 · Organisation and linking words 2 · Grammar 3 · Vocabulary 3. Accept 120–150 words.

HOW TO USE THIS WORKSHEET

Tasks 1–4 are best done as controlled practice (about 20 minutes) — they check how well students have understood the text. Task 5 works well in pairs: students ask and answer the questions, then write down their answers. Task 6 can be done in class or given as homework; a dictionary is allowed. Suggested timing: one lesson (45 minutes) + homework.

GRADING SCALE

38–42 points — '5' 30–37 points — '4' 22–29 points — '3' below 22 — revise the text and try again